

4}

- Brand
 - Merchandise Handling (Swag)
- Product and Solution Marketing
 - Core Product Marketing
 - Competitive Intelligence
 - Analyst Relations
 - Customer Advocacy
- Design
- Content

Integrated Marketing

The Integrated Marketing team is focused on creating awareness, generating demand and collaborating with the broader ecosystem globally, through a co-ordinated and unified approach. We connect the dots and bring content and messaging to life by leveraging various channels as our levers to communicate across segments, regions and personas.

The team includes Field Marketing, Global Channel Marketing, Corporate Events, Account Based Marketing, Integrated Campaigns, Lifecycle Marketing, Digital Strategy and Digital Experience.

[Handbook](/handbook/marketing/integrated-marketing/)

Handbook Links

{.h4}

- Field Marketing
- Channel Marketing
- Corporate Events
- Account Based Marketing
- Integrated Campaigns
- Lifecycle Marketing
- Digital Strategy
- Digital Experience
 - Marketing Website

Sales Development

The Sales Development organization is focused on serving the needs of prospective customers during the beginning of their buying process.

The Sales Development department is composed of 2 groups: the SDR team who handles all the inbound interest and the BDR team who specializes in outreach of prospective customers.

When prospective customers have questions about GitLab, the SDRs assist them or connect them to a technical team member as needed. During the initial exploration, if the prospective customer is interested in continuing their exploration of GitLab, SDRs will connect them to an Account Executive (AE) or Strategic Account Executive (SAE).

BDRs contact people who work at large organizations to uncover or create early-stage sales opportunities for GitLab SAEs. The BDR team will plan with their paired Sales counterpart to approach interesting accounts and develop a plan for prospecting including contact discovery, understanding enterprise-wide initiatives that GitLab could assist with, and ensuring accurate data quality of accounts and contact in salesforce.com.

[Handbook](/handbook/marketing/sales-development/)

Marketing Operations and Analytics

Marketing Operations and Analytics includes Marketing Operations, Marketing Analytics, and Globalization and Localization. The team focuses on enabling efficient operations and actionable analytics insights, working across all Marketing teams. The team also owns the MarTech stack used by Marketing.

[Handbook](/handbook/marketing/marketing-strategy-and-platforms/)

Handbook Links

{.h4}

- Marketing Operations
- Marketing Strategy & Analytics
- Globalization & Localization

Enterprise Data

The GitLab Enterprise Data Team is responsible for empowering every GitLab team member to contribute to the data program and generate business value from our data assets.

[Handbook](/handbook/enterprise-data/)

Developer Relations

Developer Relations drives platform awareness and adoption by reaching deep into wider communities and engaging developers where they are. GitLab currently engages with more than 3000 developers every month on GitLab.com alone, and receives more than 250 contributions every month, giving us a unique level of influence in the DevSecOps space and helping accelerate our innovation. Our ultimate goal is to raise awareness of GitLab and drive customer success by winning the hearts & minds of developers through best-in-class technical enablement and an active community of contributors.

[Handbook](/handbook/marketing/developer-relations/)

Handbook Links

{.h4}

- Contributor Success
- Developer Advocacy
- Community Programs

- Education Program
- Open Source Program

Corporate Communications

The mission of GitLab's Corporate Communications team is to amplify GitLab's product, people and partnerships in the media, via social media channels and through award wins. This team is responsible for global public relations (PR), social media, and executive communications (speaking).

[Handbook](/handbook/marketing/corporate-communications/)

Handbook Links

{.h4}

- Social Marketing
- Speaking Resources
- Incident Communications Plan

<i class="fas fa-calendar-check fa-fw color-orange font-awesome"></i> Marketing Calendar

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

FY25 All-Marketing SSoT Calendar

{.h3}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

The marketing team utilizes a single all-marketing calendar where everyone can contribute, and we can answer key questions (using pre-set filter views) related to upcoming marketing plans. Note: this calendar links to our internal handbook page.

Please do not filter the entire doc. Instead, you may use pre-set filter views (click down arrow selector next to the filter icon on the bookmark bar) to see activities grouped by GTM Motion, segment, region, team, language, and more.

If there are other views you would find helpful, please feel free to duplicate an existing filter view, and include some sort of categorization (i.e. team, segment, etc.). You can do this by going to a similar filter view, and clicking on the top right gear icon, then selecting Duplicate.

For more information about adding events to All-Marketing SSoT Calendar, please click [here](#).

Marketing Team Processes

This front page of the Marketing Handbook is intended to serve as the external face of the marketing team. We've created a dedicated Team Processes page that is intended to house our internal processes, workflows, and guidances relevant internally to the marketing team.

[Visit the Page](/handbook/marketing/marketing-team-processes/)

SECTION: marketing/cmo-shadow.md

Overview {overview}

Introduction {introduction}

At GitLab, being a CMO shadow is not a job title, but a temporary assignment to shadow the CMO. The shadows will be present at all meetings of the CMO during their rotation. GitLab is an all-remote company, so the shadow will be attending virtual meetings hosted on Zoom.

Goal {goal}

The goal of the CMO Shadow Program is to give current and future leaders in the Marketing Team an overview of all aspects of the company.

This should enable marketing leadership to better perform global optimizations.

You'll gain this context through the meetings you attend and discussions with the CMO regarding any questions that arise during the call, should time be available during the shadow timeframe.

The program also creates opportunities for the CMO to build relationships with team members across the marketing department and to identify challenges and opportunities earlier.

What it is not {what-it-is-not}

The CMO Shadow Program is not a performance evaluation or the next step to a promotion. Being a CMO shadow is not needed to get a promotion or a raise, and should not be a consideration factor for a promotion or raise, as diverse participants have different eligibilities.

Reasons to participate {reasons-to-participate}

1. Are you interested in learning more about marketing's interaction with other departments within the company?

1. Are you interested in how other leaders within marketing run their 1:1s with CMO or run their team meetings and you're looking for leadership inspiration you can take back to your team?

What is it like? {what-it-is-like}

- CMO days are very interesting. One moment, you will be talking about a press strategy and the next, you'll be in pipeline conversations. Depending on the meeting, some may give you context of what you're hearing or some may not. If limited context is given, then you're quickly trying to dig into the data that's been presented so you can glean as much information from the meeting as possible, before going on to the next.

What is the feedback from the CMO? {cmo-feedback}

(To be developed) Hear what our CMO has to say about the CMO Shadow Program.

Participating in the program {participation}

Eligibility {eligibility}

CMO staff will recommend who from their organizations should participate in the program. If you're a team member reading this and interested in participating, reach out to your CMO staff member.

Rotation schedule {schedule}

Start date	End date	Shadow & Role
-----	-----	-----
2021-05-17	2021-05-28	Michael Preuss - Director, Digital Experience
2021-05-31	2021-06-11	Available
2021-06-14	2021-06-25	Available

Preparing for the Program {preparation}

Important things to note {things-to-note}

1. This is not a performance evaluation.
1. Plan to observe and ask questions.
1. Don't plan to do any of your usual work. Prepare your team as if you were on vacation.
1. Be ready to add a number of handbook updates during your shadow period.
1. Participating in the shadow program is a privilege where you will be exposed to confidential information. This is underpinned by trust in the shadows to honor the confidentiality of topics being discussed and information shared. The continuation of this program is entirely dependent on shadows past, present, and future honoring this trust placed in them.
1. Give feedback to and receive feedback from the CMO. Participants in the shadow program are encouraged to deliver candid feedback. Examples of this are to the CMO and to the world about the company if they make a blog post or video. Shadows maintaining confidentiality during the program is separate from shadows being able to provide candid feedback.

What to wear {what-to-wear}

You do not need to dress formally; business casual clothes are appropriate. For example, Todd wears a button-up with jeans most days. GitLab shirts are acceptable. Review Todd's calendar to check if there are formal occasions - this may require different clothing. If unsure, please ask the Executive Business Administrator (EBA).

Pre-Program Tasks {pre-program-tasks}

Practice your introduction {practice-introduction}

You will get asked about yourself during the program, and it's important to describe it correctly. So stand in front of a mirror and practice 3 times. The main point is, do not say that your role is to "follow Todd around" or "follow the CMO around". The program is for exploring and learning about all the parts of GitLab, and there's where the emphasis should lie.

Review the CMO's calendar {review-calendar}

Review the CMO's calendar to get an idea of what your upcoming weeks will be like. If you see there is a meeting on the CMO calendar and you're not invited, but think you should be, feel free to ask CMO or the EBA directly.

Include CMO Shadow in Zoom Name {zoom-name}

Shadows should update their name in Zoom to include [Name] | CMO Shadow for clarity in meetings.

Coffee Chat with CMO Shadow Alumni {alumni-coffee-chat}

Feel free to schedule a coffee chat with any of the CMO Shadow Alumni. You can review the list of CMO Shadow Alumni below. These chats can be helpful when deciding whether to participate or if you want to hear about the experience and what alumni have learned while shadowing.

What to expect during the program {what-to-expect}

Tasks {tasks}

At times you may be asked your opinion on a topic or you may be asked to do work if it is specifically related to your job.

Meetings {meetings}

You are welcome to come off mute and join the conversation. Ask questions where you see appropriate. If you're more comfortable to dropping a line in chat, meeting attendees will see the note and often times, vocalize your comment and may ask for more insight.

Taking Notes {taking-notes}

Depending on the meeting, you may be asked to take notes for the meeting. Depending on how you work, you may want to take notes of your own. Noting what you thought was interesting about the conversation, how you think it impacts your role/team, and any follow-ups you want to personally take as a result of what you heard.

Follow activity from the CMO {follow-cmo-activity}

Shadows are encouraged to follow the CMO's activity on various platforms to get a complete picture of his everyday activities and where he directs his attention.

- In Slack: Go to the Slack search bar and type "from:@tbarr" and it will populate the results.
- In GitLab: This can be seen on the CMO's GitLab activity log.

Alumni {alumni}

<!-- Do we want this? -->

| Start date | End date | Name | Title | Takeaways |

-----	-----	----	----	-----
2021-01-04	2021-01-22	Jackie Gragnola	Manager, Campaigns	
2021-01-18	2021-01-29	Leslie Blanchard	Director, Field Marketing	
2021-02-01	2021-02-12	Becky Reich	Awareness Campaign Manager	
2021-02-22	2021-03-05	Emily Kyle	Manager, Corporate Events and Branding	
2021-03-15	2021-03-26	William Chia	Manager, Product Marketing	
2021-03-29	2021-04-09	Hannah Woodward	Sr. Manager, AMER Sales Development	
2021-04-19	2021-04-30	Natasha Woods	Director, Corporate Communications	
2021-05-03	2021-05-14	Emily Luehrs	Manager, Account Based Marketing	

SECTION: marketing/cmo.md

<i class="fas fa-bullhorn fa-fw color-orange font-awesome"></i> Welcome to the GitLab CMO Handbook
 {.h1}

This page details processes for the Chief Marketing Officer at GitLab, including review and approval requests, communication guidelines, and information-sharing best practices.

Communication guidelines

In an effort to create more efficiency in how we collaborate, please utilize the cmo Slack channel for items that require CMO review, feedback, approval, to share updates, or if you have questions directly to the CMO.

Note this is a public Slack channel, so please consider it is SAFE before sharing.

Review and Approvals

Follow the steps and details for workflows that involve different types of review requests for efficient reviews.

- Join the cmo Slack channel to create a new review request
 - Tag @Ashley
 - Include the URL to the MR or slides/docs
 - Add a short sentence describing the topic, and ask.
 - Optional: Add more context in subsequent lines in the message, or as a reply into a new message thread.
- Ensure that direct reports to the CMO have reviewed and approved before asking the CMO to review
 - Example: A new product messaging house is developed, and the VP of Product Marketing must sign off first.
 - Example: The marketing handbook front page adds a new strategic vision for events. The VP of Integrated Marketing, and the VP of Product Marketing must sign off first.
- Please add CMO's EBA as CC into the message and include a due date until when the review is required.
 - The CMO's EBA will add a notification to the CMO's calendar to finish the review request on the same day/week.

- Example: Urgent review ask because of the new quarter starting in two weeks, requiring the new messaging. Please review by YYYY-MM-DD, 5 PM PT. cc @<EBA name>

Example review request:

text

@Ashley This MR adds the CMO review requests and communication guidelines page into the marketing handbook. https://gitlab.com/gitlab-com/www-gitlab-com/-/merge_requests/115432

Context is your request to create a dedicated Slack channel, and documented guidelines for team members to share review requests and content updates, similar to the ceo Slack channel.

Please review until 2022-12-01 10am PT. cc @Laura Vickerman

Follow-up actions: Share with CMO leadership, add an update for the next Marketing all-hands meeting.

Merge Requests

Before assigning the CMO for review and approval, please ensure that the following applies:

- The MR is mergeable: All comment threads resolved, MR is marked as ready and not a draft, and CI/CD pipelines ran successfully and deployed the latest review app.
- Add @akramer as a Reviewer to the MR. You can use /assignreviewer @akramer as a quick action in the comment (press r as keyboard shortcut)
- Optional: Share a Review App URL for direct access to relevant changes and pages, or add a screenshot/summary in the request for more efficient reviews.

Follow the best practices for merge request reviews in the CEO handbook.

Sharing content to read

If you have an interesting article or news item to read and learn, feel free to share it in the cmo Slack channel too.

- Add FYI, without @-tagging the CMO in the beginning of the Slack message. This avoids notification distractions and enables async reading.
- Create a summary of 1-3 sentences with key talking points and take aways.
- Add screenshots, or source URLs for better context
- Optional: Suggested actions: that suggest a follow-up task for the CMO.
 - Example: Retweet/Reshare a Twitter/LinkedIn share, or share an article in the network for thought leadership.

SECTION: marketing/efficiency-wg-fy24.md

Attributes

Property	Value
Date Created	2023-07-18
End Date	2023-10-31
Slack	wgmarketingefficiencyfy24
Google Doc	Working Group Doc
Overview & Status	Epic

Overview

The FY'24 Pulse Engagement survey ran from 2023-05-16 to 2023-06-27.

Efficiency was identified a Marketing Department focus area. This working group was established to identify and solution 3-5 key areas for efficiency improvement.

Objectives

1. Agree 3-5 key areas for efficiency improvement. As a team, identify the WHY & ROI, solution the improvement.
2. Develop communication and change management plan.
3. Implement change

Business Outcomes & Exit Criteria

TBD

Risks & Interdependencies

TBD

Timeline

FY24 Q3: 2023-08-01 - 2023-10-31

Roles and Responsibilities

- DRI: Nikki Silverberg
- Sponsor: Denise Parsonage
- Working Group Members: Allison Graban, Amruta Kulkarni, Brian Mason, Eirini Panagiotopoulou, Ginny Reib, Indre Kryzeviciene, Katie Rogel, Mao Nogales Lazarini, Michael Friedrich

SECTION: marketing/emergency-response.md

Marketing emergency response

At times GitLab needs to communicate a "breaking" change or details related to a high-priority emergency patch. These emails are transactional and are highly targeted to the impacted audience.

Not an emergency? For important planned customer communications, please use the customer update/announcement process, to enable teams to work together and plan without the urgency of an emergency request.

As soon as an emergency communication is recognized, the Requesting team MUST:

1. Create an incident communication request
1. Review the S1 coverage matrix below and assign the issue and tag the coverage owner closest available per their timezone in the mktgops Slack channel.
1. If there is not a timely response in Slack, please review the coverage owners' Slack profile and send them a quick call or text. If no timely response, tag @mktg-ops within the mktgops Slack channel or use escalation path below.
1. In the template the requesting team will include details including CTA, email body, send date and provide link to Google sheet containing list.
1. If security, make sure to follow instructions

Coverage Matrix

Please review the coverage owner closest available per their timezone when deciding who to reach out to.

MOPs Team Coverage		PT / ET Time Available			
Coverage Owner: Monday - Friday		Backup: Monday - Friday		Coverage Owner GEO Time	
-----		-----		-----	
-----		-----			
UTC (EMEA Working)		11pm - 3am PT / 2am - 6am ET		Mihai Conteanu	
Gillian Murphy		9am - 1pm EET			
UTC (EMEA Working)		3am - 7am PT / 6am - 10am ET		Gillian Murphy	
Mihai Conteanu		11am - 3pm UK			
UTC (AMER-Morning)		7am - 11am PT / 10am - 2pm ET		Bryce	
Weatherford		Jameson Burton		10am - 2pm ET	
UTC (AMER-Afternoon)		11am - 3pm PT / 2pm - 6pm ET		Bryce	
Weatherford		Jenny Tiemann		11am - 3pm PT	
UTC (AMER-Evening)		3pm - 6pm PT / 6pm - 9pm ET		Bryce	
Weatherford		Amy Waller		3pm - 6pm PT	

Typical Team Timezones:

Amy: PST Pacific Standard Time UTC:-8:00
Jenny: PST Pacific Standard Time UTC:-8:00
Nikki: MST Mountain Time UTC:-7:00
Bryce: MST Mountain Time UTC:-7:00
Jameson: MST Mountain Time UTC: -5:00
Gillian: GMT Greenwich Mean Time UTC: +1:00
Mihai: EET Eastern European Time UTC: +2:00

Timezone Converter

Escalation Path:

Outside of normal working hours, we do not have an "on call" procedure, so please follow this escalation path if you cannot reach anyone in the matrix above.

mktgops

Manager (Amy Waller)

If still no response, use Text or Whatsapp to contact Amy via the number in her slack profile.

If you cannot reach her, try to reach out to a timezone appropriate member in the matrix above.

Roles and responsibilities

Requestor responsibilities

Alerting email team as soon as possible that there may be a send (even if it does not move forward)

Providing FINAL email, landing page, form copy, autoresponder copy, etc.

NOTE: The addition of each item will increase scope and potentially delay announcement

Requesting target list from the Marketing Strategy & Analytics team

Creating Email request issue

Providing approval list and who signs off on the email

Legal, Customer Service VP and VP of the function who is initiating the communication (i.e., Security, Engineering, Infrastructure) are required to sign off

Notifying affected field teams (Customer Success, CSM, SAE/AE, SA, Professional Services)

Also make sure to notify sales and customer-success before email is set to go out

Approving test email

Providing any edits to the test email

Providing send time and date

Approving all other materials and workflows (landing pages, forms, completion actions)

Email team responsibilities

Providing a timeline based on the request

Creating epic and some issues (all except for the target list or email request issues)

Building the email program and actual emails in Marketo (or sending platform of choice)

Uploading target list to Marketo (or sending platform of choice)

Sending test emails to requestors to approve

Making one round of changes to the emails

Creating form and Marketo landing page (if needed)

Building workflows for form completion actions

Deploying emails

Providing email performance report, email link click reports, and form/landing page reports

Creating SFDC campaign if needed (if needed)

Coordinating SDR routing needs with Marketing Ops

Standard process

This is the process to follow when there is an announcement that is an emergency that will need to be sent by the marketing ops team. The marketing ops team will determine what platform will be used based on the information that is provided to them such as timing, list size and severity.

1. Requesting team notifies that an emergency communication is needed

Immediately slack mktgops and include the incident issue and the incident slack channel. If there is not a prompt response, follow on-call procedures.

2. Issue Creation

Request issue utilizing Incident Communications template in the Marketing Operations project.

Fill in as many blanks as you can with as much information as you have available - the issue template will walk you through what is needed. Feel free to add any additional context that may be helpful. If you do not have all the information, that is OK, as we know it is an ongoing development.

Add Due Date (or best guess)

Include googledoc of copy document, even if it is blank. Use this template

Please make sure to review the copy for any RED Data.

Include approx size of the list - this will determine what email platform we will use and helps immensely in our planning. Over estimate when you are unsure.

If you are requesting a list, create an issue with the Marketing Strategy team and relate it to the issue you just created.

Include any custom fields you need created for mail-merge in the email. Include field max lengths needed, or best guess. Mktops will determine if they can use an existing field or not.

Note if the links should not be trackable.

3. Issue in Process

Marketing team will work closely with you to develop a communication plan and cadence. Please continue to add information as you receive it and over communicate with us via slack/issue.

List size and complexity will determine what email platform we will need to use.

4. Approvals

The following approvers are needed for the copy and list size:

Vice President of Customer Success

Vice President of the function who is initiating the communication (i.e., Security, Engineering, Infrastructure)

Legal (copy only)

Customer Comms and PR

Marketing Operations Manager

Appropriate field teams driven by the scope of customers receiving the communication (SAE/AE, SA, CSM, Professional Services)

Support, if there is any call to action in the communication to contact support

5. Email Ready to Deploy

Email team will send a sample to the requestor and approvers for their review - preferably, there is a quick Zoom sync to double check send size, variable fields, email copy and time of send.

Requestor and approvers must approve in the issue before the email will be sent.
Requestor sends alert to sales and customer-success on slack

6. Email Launched

The email team will provide stats minutes after launch, and at a cadence determined by the announcement team as necessary.

- Note: Full email stats mature at 48 hours.

Inbox monitoring will be done by the requesting team, unless otherwise stated.

Lists

1. For most emergency communications the requesting team should be providing a list as a Google Sheet in the issue request.

The Marketing Strategy and Performance team is able to pull a list from user table if necessary. Please create an issue with them.

Often, this is done using the Marketing Contact Mart in DBT. The mart has fields for persons in SFDC marked as GitLab Admins, CustomerDB Owners, and Zoura Admins.

1. General security alerts already have a distro list built in marketo.

1. Seldomly, lists need to be created in Salesforce or Marketo using parameters found within the marketing database.

Marketo & Salesforce do not contain all records within the user table

List considerations

List loads greater than 20k take time. 100k+ may take hours/days.

Each platform has their own limits as to size of CSV that can be uploaded.

Lists greater than 100k may be subject to verification, so that we do not risk our sending reputation.

Avoid listing any RED Data in mail-merge fields

Other considerations and questions for requestors

Send / Reply-to email

Should there be an auto-responder?

Will someone be monitoring the email address?

If unmonitored, does the email mention that?

Email platform to use

Marketing Operations will decide what the best email platform to send from will be. The decision is based on many factors.

Marketo

Gainsight

Marketing Operations Set-Up

Clone from incident template

Ensure that processing requests Do not Route executable campaign

Mark Person source for new leads as GitLab DataMart
Person Status should be set to Raw if Empty
Processing campaign can be set up as a trigger or batch depending on list size
Set up reports if not using the email program defaults
Follow remaining steps in the incident issue template

Mops steps and checklist for large sends

For sends over 100k sending from Marketo, there are several steps to follow to decrease processing time - especially when leads being uploaded are mostly net-new

1. Check list over to remove any sanctioned countries and/or GitLab email addresses
1. Identify common processing campaigns to update with list suppression filters. These trigger off of person created which will significantly delay processing time and hold up all other Marketo campaign processes (outside of this program)
 1. Generic Email Trigger
 1. OP-Generic Email Address Scoring
 1. OptOuts after 9.10 - Trigger
 1. 01a ZoomInfo Enrich - non API leads
 1. Add to nurture
 1. Spam catcher
 1. OP-Level/Seniority Segment Scoring
 1. OP-Role/Function Segment Scoring
 1. Generic Email Trigger 2023
 1. OP-Lead Classification - Created/Ongoing
 1. Populate Generic Email Checking Field
1. Set up priority send controller campaign to improve speed of send
1. If send list is over 250,000, you must update the smart campaign limits.
1. Ensure email is marked operational, otherwise you may need to update email communication limits
1. After send, discuss with legal to delete unnecessary records out of Marketo.

Common Troubleshooting

1. Email won't send
 - Check smart campaign limits, is the send over the limit amount?
 - If email isn't marked operational, you may have to update email comm limits, or mark the email as operational (if this is the case, make sure to double check your filters)
1. Email needs to send out faster than 15 minutes
 - Set up smart campaign to send the email vs using the email program default settings

SECTION: marketing/journeys.md

Introduction

As a company we have to be great at providing multiple journeys.
The contributor, user, and buyer journey involve different people going through them, different metrics, different hand-offs, and different teams providing them.

Most companies never master a journey, a few companies master one: Ubuntu mastered the contributor journey, Atlassian the user journey, and Oracle the buyer journey. Our ambition is to master all three.

The hard thing is that during a journey you have multiple hand-offs between departments and teams.

These hand-off points need to be well defined and work for both teams.

It is essential to measure all steps of the journey to see where an improvement would have the greatest effect.

Contributor journey

A contributor is someone who contributed to GitLab with code, documentation, a blog article, a tweet, a talk, a meetup, and/or helping on the issue tracker/forum/irc.

1. Find GitLab (technical blog post)
1. Reach out to GitLab on social media (social media response)
1. Find information about contributing (contributor landing pages)
1. Start installation of GDK (multiple good options to run)
1. Finish installation of GDK (error free, good troubleshooting)
1. Submit a merge request (good documentation)
1. Get acknowledged (find first contributor)
1. Finish merge request (acknowledge first contribution, merge request coach)
1. Help someone else (forum, issue tracker)
1. Get recognized for a large contribution (named swag)
1. Get recognized as an core contributor (core contributor program, we need to know their location, maybe do this as part our forum)
1. Get invited to an event (match contributors with incoming requests for speakers, meetup organization, speaker content)
1. Write a blog post (help with editing)
1. Get activated after being inactive for a while (reactivation program)

People might skip parts of this journey, for example by never contributing code. That is perfectly fine.

User journey

Stage	Measured By	GitLab Owner	
-----	-----	-----	
Aware	?	Marketing	
Download	Downloads	Marketing?	
Install	Usage Pings ?	Distribution	
Single User Experience	Usage Ping	UX	
Invite Other Users	Usage Ping	?	
Adopt All Features	Usage Ping	? Product & Marketing	
Invite Other Departments	Usage Ping	?	
Internal Reference	?	?	

User adoption journey

Our customers get the most value out of the GitLab product when they use multiple stages. The user adoption journey covers the most common path our users follow to adopt GitLab's product stages.

Buyer journey

Stage	Measured By
GitLab Owner	Activities
----- ----- ----- ----- -----	

Awareness	Impressions/Share of Voice
Marketing	Blog, SEO, Ads, Campaign, AR, PR
Initial Contact	Get in touch with us
Marketing	Trial, chat, or contact sales
Consideration	Willingness to talk
Marketing and Sales	Initial Qualifying Meeting
Enter Buying Cycle	Pipeline stage movement
Progress through pipeline stages	
Decision/Purchase	Dollar amount in contract
Sales, Finance, Legal	Sign our paper/submit PO
Adoption	Usage ping of different DevOps stages
Customer Success	
Reference	Scale of reference-ability: e.g. more points for video; then blog; public reference; private reference
Contribute	More than a reference, the customer contributes to the GitLab project or community
Community Advocates	Code; feature requests; Customer Advisory Boards

Buyer's journey content stages

Refer to our handbook page on buyer's journey definitions for a more detailed explanation.

Awareness (Beginning stage)

Users and buyers realize that they have a problem or challenge which could be solved through some sort of outside software or service. At this stage, they are trying to define the scope and the relative impact and size of the problem.

The focus is on educating potential buyers about the problems they are facing, the business impact of their problems, and the reality that others are successfully solving the same problem.

Consideration (Middle stage)

Users and buyers understand the problem they are trying to solve and the business impact/value of addressing the problem and are now actively seeking and evaluating potential remedies to their business issue. In this stage they are focused on identifying options that meet their specific requirements and needs.

The focus is on positioning GitLab as a viable and compelling solution to a potential buyer's specific problem.

Decision/Purchase (Later stage)

Users and buyers have concluded that they need to invest in solving a specific business problem and are now comparing and evaluating specific options. In this stage, they are evaluating and comparing different options in order to identify the ideal solution for their specific situation.

The focus is on key information that a buyer needs to justify GitLab as their chosen solution.

SECTION: marketing/marketing-enablement.md

<link rel="stylesheet" type="text/css" href="/stylesheets/biztech.css" />

<i class="far fa-newspaper" id="biz-tech-icons"></i> Charter

Intra-Department Learning: Marketing Functional Conversations

The goal of Intra-Department Learning is to create, conduct, and host cross-department learning sessions to drive collaboration and understanding of marketing functional team priorities.

Marketing Functional Conversations are modeled after Group conversations. While Group Conversations offer high-level insights, Marketing Functional Conversations are meant to drill deeper into the various functions within the Marketing Department. The goal of Marketing Functional Conversations is to create increased awareness and mutual understanding of the functions within Marketing. Awareness and understanding is an essential building block for effective collaboration.

Intra-Department Learning is a Key Result (KR) of a CMO OKR in Q3&4FY24-Q1FY24 to Align as one unified Marketing team, ensuring team member growth, communication, and collaboration (actioning pulse engagement survey feedback). The Collaboration workstream team is actioning the Marketing Functional Conversations. The DRI for marketing enablement is TBD after the OKR work is completed.

Structure

The Intra-Department Learning Sessions consists of three parts:

Session Recording: The recorded session will be linked to the table below and hosted on unfiltered (private or public depending on SAFE guidelines).

Functional Conversation + Deck: After the recording is posted and shared, a Functional Conversation will occur during regularly occurring and pre-scheduled time slots. The Functional Conversation is hosted by the team and is an AMA-style session where all marketing team members can attend and ask questions about the shared materials. All team members are encouraged to ask questions and dig deeper in order to gain a better understanding. Team members who want to

participate but are not able to attend synchronously are encouraged to embrace asynchronous communication by contributing questions or comments in advance of meetings and watching recordings or reading notes after.

Marketing All-Hands Meetings Notification Item: After the AMA session is completed, a Functional Conversation notification item will be added to an upcoming Marketing All-hands meeting. The agenda item will link to the recording, deck, and notes from the AMA.

Example Prompts

Use these prompts to guide your session content. The focus should be on how other teams collaborate with you team.

What goals and priorities drive your team?

How can team members get in touch with your team? (public slack channels, etc)

How can team members request help from your team? (issue requests, etc.)

Are there opportunities to collaborate with your team that may not be obvious?

Intra-Department Learning Sessions

Function	Team	Slack Channel	Handbook Page	Slide Deck	Session Recording
----- ----- ----- ----- ----- -----					
----- ----- ----- ----- ----- -----					

Session cadence

The Intra-Department Learning Sessions for each department are to be recorded and shared in Q4FY23.

SECTION: marketing/marketing-strategy-and-platforms.md

Marketing Strategy, Operations, and Analytics Team Charter

Mission & Objectives

Our mission is to enable efficient operations and actionable analytics insights, working across all Marketing teams.

| 1. Actionable Insights

| 2. Continuous Optimization

| 3. Experience Integration

|

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| |
| |
| Team(s)

- Strategy & Analytics
| Team(s)

- Marketing Operations | Team(s)

- Globalization |
| Theme
Incrementality
| Theme
Experimentation
| Theme
Guided Journey
|

Resource Allocation

Balance Short Term Focus & Long Term Goals. We will be disciplined yet stay nimble in resource allocation & prioritization.

Core: ~ 70%

- Deliver conversion lift & pipeline goals across segments & sales motions
- Provide clear visibility and insights to marketing performance KPIs
- Improve operational efficiency
- Enhance security and privacy posture

Strategic: ~ 25%

- Build a strong foundation for global expansion
- Design a seamless in-product, e-commerce, and web navigation experience

Venture: ~ 5%

- Leverage embedded analytics to drive acquisition and expansion

Roles & Responsibilities

Marketing Technologists

Performance Assessment

Four Funnels

	Self-Serve
Sales-Assisted	
Bottom-Up	
Top Down	
-----	-----
-----	-----

-----	-----
-----	-----

----- |
 | Sales Motion | No Touch
 | Transactional
 | Land & Expand
 | Outbound, ABM
 |
 | Persona / Segment | SMB core user, Community user
 | Mid-Market core-user, SMB buyer
 | Large Mid-Market, Enterprise
 | Enterprise
 |
 | Kain Goal of the PLG Motion | Self-Serve Revenue
 | Pipeline Generation
 | Expansion Revenue
 | Sales Enablement
 |
 | Main Funnel Goal | Self-Serve ARR
 | Expansion ARR on top of Self-Serve ARR
 | Pipeline generation on top of new teams
 | Pipeline generation on key accounts
 |
 | Funnel | | | |

Communication Norms

Develop habits & make incremental progress

- $1.01^{365} = 37.78$
- $0.99^{365} = 0.026$

Collaborate with & learn from diverse sources

> "If you want to go fast, go alone. If you want to go far, go together."

Ground Rules

- We learn from each other by fostering group intelligence
- We lean towards innovation and collaborative decision-making by being bold, but not bully, and being thoughtful, but not lazy
- We cultivate growth mindset by having the courage to try new things and fail better
- We're stronger as a team by sharing the workload, and not minding who gets the credit

> "The most important function of the leader is to encourage everyone to see him- or herself as a member of the larger system, pursuing a common vision, holding common values, and cooperating with each other in an environment of mutual support and respect."

FRED KOFMAN

Interdependencies

Within Marketing

Team	Interdependencies

Product Marketing	- Messaging & Content - SEO
Integrated Marketing	- Campaign Strategy & Execution Plan - Field & Partner Rules of Engagement
Brand	- Brand Design

Other Functions

Team	Interdependencies
-----	-----
Finance & Business Technology	- Financial Planning & Budget - Data Engineering
Field Sales & Operations	- Segment & Global Expansion Priority - Sales Process, Rules of Engagement & Salesforce Data Quality
Product & Engineering	- E-commerce Product Roadmap - Engineering Resource
Legal	- Regulations & Compliance Related to User Analytics

SECTION: marketing/marketing-team-processes.md

<link rel="stylesheet" type="text/css" href="/stylesheets/biztech.css" />

<i class="fas fa-calendar-check fa-fw color-orange font-awesome"></i> Marketing Calendar

Adding to the All-Marketing Calendar {marketing-calendar-inputs}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

Location for inputs: In your Google Drive, search for (and bookmark) FY24 All-Marketing Calendar SSoT.

This is where all teams will input and categorize planned activities - with filters that align to key pieces of information (GTM Motion, Alliance Partners, Sales Segments, Regions, Language, and more). This will be iterative and everyone should feel open to share their feedback and ideas - comment in the issue to share your thoughts!

Marketing team additions to All-Marketing Calendar {inputs-marketing-additions}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

The instructions below are to be followed by marketing team members. Add a row at bottom of All-Marketing Calendar spreadsheet or insert in the appropriate date (either way, this will be re-sorted by marketing periodically). If you don't have all the details, don't worry - fill in what you can and work together to outline the information that is valuable for integrating our marketing tactics as a team.

BASIC DETAILS

Day of Week: (don't edit, this is a formula that will work off of the dates you add)

Dates: Add date(s) of event

If the event is not multi-day, only add Start Date. If spans multiple days, please include both start and end date.

Team / DRI: Choose DRI (primary) that is project managing the activity from the drop-down list

Activity Category: Choose category from drop-down list

Name: Add the exact name of the tactic/event (if not final, include latest available, or placeholder with focus on <add topic> if not yet determined)

Corporate Events: Include "SPONSORING" next to events that we are sponsoring in green font

KEY LINKS

Landing Page: Once a landing page is created, please link here for easy access by Sales and Marketing.

Epic/Issue: If there is an epic (events, content, webcasts, etc.), add the epic link. If there is not an epic level (i.e. digital channel launch), include issue link.

GTM & PARTNER ALIGNMENT

Primary GTM Motion: Choose the most closely aligned GTM Motion (from FY24 GTM Motions (Automated Software Delivery OR Security & Compliance)

Alliance Partner(s): If an alliance partner is included in the activity, please add all in this column.

Channel Partner(s): If a channel partner is included in the activity, please add all in this column.

AUDIENCE DETAILS

Sales Segment: Choose from drop-down (if focused on a specific sales segment).

Note that PubSec is a Sales Segment.

Primary Region: Choose from the drop-down (if focused on a specific region)

Primary Sub-Region: Choose from the drop-down (if focused on a specific sub-region)

Language: If language other than English, please add here.

SUPPORTING TEAM COMMITMENTS

SDR/BDR Commitment: Added by SDR Leadership

BDR Approved - DRI Manager: Added by SDR Leadership

BDRs Attending: Added by SDR Leadership

SDR Attending: Added by SDR Leadership

SA/TM Commitment: Added by Marketing

Customer Speaker?: Include if there is a customer speaker for the activity.

Mockup of All-Marketing Calendar (Future Visualization) {marketing-calendar-mockup}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

In the future, the goal is to visualize these inputs in a calendar format with filters (based on columns in the doc) to allow the team to see the plans in Sisense. View the Basic Mockup in FigJam!

Currently, the GoogleDoc has pre-set filter views to help you see plans by Region, Segment, etc. to be added by team members for their respective activities.

FY23 All-Marketing SSoT Calendar {fy23-calendar}

<!-- DO NOT CHANGE ANCHOR -->

The marketing team utilizes a single all-marketing calendar where everyone can contribute, and we can answer key questions (using filters) related to upcoming marketing plans.

Please do not filter the entire doc (although Google Docs is now allowing personal filtering that doesn't affect all other viewers in the doc - need to test this!). Instead, you may use pre-set filter views (click down arrow selector next to the filter icon on the bookmark bar) to see activities grouped by GTM Motion, segment, region, team, funnel stage, partners, and more.

Below are some pre-set filter examples:

- GTM - CI/CD
- GTM - DevOps Platform
- GTM - GitOps
- GTM - Brand/Remote
- Team - Corporate Events
- Region - EMEA
- Month - April

If there are other views you would find helpful, please feel free to duplicate an existing filter view, and include some sort of categorization (i.e. team, segment, etc.). You can do this by going to a similar filter view, and clicking on the top right gear icon, then selecting Duplicate.

<i class="fas fa-toolbox fa-fw color-orange font-awesome"></i> Marketing Project Management Guidelines

Marketing uses GitLab for agile project management including groups, projects, epics, roadmaps, issues, labels, and boards. Read through the documentation on each of these GitLab features if you are unfamiliar.

Integrated Campaigns

Marketing Departments collaborate to produce Integrated Campaigns. An Integrated Campaign is a communication effort that includes several campaign tactics such as blog posts, emails, events, advertisements, content on about.gitlab.com, videos, case studies, whitepapers, surveys, social

outreach, and webcasts. An Integrated Campaign will have a campaign theme that summarizes the message we are communicating to our market.

Active integrated campaigns

Active integrated campaigns

Have a new campaign idea? Make a suggestion

Project Management Processes

We cultivate a deep understanding of our own product by using GitLab to manage our planning, collaboration, and execution of Marketing activities.

The latest Project Management recommendations can be found here from FY21-Q2 Agility Project

Milestones

The latest recommendations for Milestones from FY21-Q2 Agility Project

Weekly Sprints

Within the [www-gitlab-com](#) repo (parent repo to Marketing) there are weekly milestones, which some teams use plan a weekly sprint cadence. Each of these sprints begins with "Fri:" for the Friday upon which that sprint ends, making them searchable in a list [here](#).

Each week on Monday, any open MRs and issues still assigned to the previous week's milestone are bulk moved forward to the next week, and the previous milestone is closed out. This is a manual process currently performed by Danielle.

Groups and projects

The latest recommendations for Groups and Projects from FY21-Q2 Agility Project

1. The Marketing Group houses all marketing projects.

1. Labels should be created at the group level so they can be used in all projects within Marketing group.

Labels should not be duplicated in individual projects. It creates board/tracking conflicts.

1. The following are the approved marketing projects, CMO approval is needed to begin a new project.

- Product Marketing (includes PMM, TMM, and Market Insights)

- Developer Relations

- Digital Marketing Programs

- Demand Generation

- Corporate Marketing (includes content, website, corp events, brand, etc. - old location in deprecated group, to be updated)

- Marketing Operations

- Field Marketing

- Account Based Strategy

Sales Development Organization

Digital Advertising - used for external advertising agency

Onboarding

Contribute - this is a sub-group that contains all projects for each Contribute event

Growth Marketing

Partner Marketing (includes both tech partner and channel marketing)

1. Issues should be logged in the team project ultimately responsible for completing requested work. (i.e. If SDR needs list uploaded -> issue created in Marketing Operations project).

Issues, Milestones, and Epics

The latest recommendations for Epics and the latest for Issues from FY21-Q2 Agility Project

1. Each issue represents a discrete unit of work with a deliverable. For example 1 2 3
1. Every MR should have an issue so that it can be tracked on issue boards.
1. Milestones represent units of work to be completed within a specific time frame, sometimes referred to as sprints. They are comprised of multiple issues that share a common due date, and help break large projects into more manageable parts.
1. Epics represent projects that comprise multiple issues. (Don't use "meta" issues for this purpose. If you have an existing meta issue you can promote them to epics using the /promote quick command.)
 - Epics live at the group level (e.g. issue from multiple marketing projects can be added to an epic.)
 - Epics are labeled with a group label of the team that owns the epic.
1. The top 3-5 strategic initiatives are tracked in epics using the CMO label. (Don't apply the CMO label to other epics.)
1. Roadmaps are used for time-based display of epics with a start and end date. (for example, events and time-based campaigns.)

Boards and Labels

The latest recommendations for Labels and the latest for boards from FY21-Q2 Agility Project

1. Each team has one or more boards to track ongoing workstreams.
1. Generally, create a board for each function. (For example PMM has boards for Sales Enablement, Analyst Relations, Customer Relations, etc.)
1. Each board uses a standard set of columns/labels so that folks can easily understand what is happening on another teams board.
1. The board labels use group scoped labels with mktg-status:: and one of four statuses. Status labels should be used on all issues within the Marketing group:
 - mktg-status::plan - work that is proposed, in an exploratory state.
 - To exit the plan stage the work must be assigned to a DRI.
 - DRI accepts responsibility for the task by changing the label from mktg-status::plan to mktg-status::wip and creating an merge request (MR), if appropriate. The plan status is optional, as issues that don't require formal planning can be opened and labeled mktg-status::wip.
 - mktg-status::wip - work in progress that has been accepted and assigned to a DRI.
 - Work in this stage should not be merged.
 - Merge requests (MRs) should be prepended with WIP:. At GitLab we allow reviewers to start reviewing right away before work is complete.

Use MVCs: At any time, if the work is complete enough that merging would be better than what currently exists the issue should be labeled with `mktg-status::review` and WIP: should be removed from the title.

Optional: `mktg-status::review` - work has been completed enough that it is ready for formal review and approval.

Work that is approved can be either merged or scheduled.

The review status is optional.

Work that doesn't require review can simply be merged/closed.

Optional: `mktg-status::scheduled` - work that is complete but should be scheduled for a future date.

Scheduled status is optional as not all work will need to be scheduled.

closed - when work is delivered the issue should be closed.

1. Don't duplicate status labels at the project level. Use group labels (at the Marketing Group level) as much as possible.

Department Labels

Each Department within Marketing can have "additive" labels - meaning they are used to enhance the tracking and workflows for that respective team. These "additive" labels are used in conjunction with the broader Marketing labels. The Department label usage is documented on each of the respective handbook pages:

Marketing Programs

Operations

Sales Development Organization

Field Marketing

Account Based Marketing

Default Issue Text

All of the projects within the Marketing subgroup include default issue text to ensure the Department labels are applied consistently and broader adoption of the global Marketing labels.

Using Default Issue Text

When a new issue is opened in any project, the issue description will contain a small snippet of text applying that team's label & Marketing scoped `mktg-status::plan` label.

If a template is chosen, a message will appear confirming you want to change the text w/in the issue description, click Apply Template and continue as normal

Updating Default Issue Text

The default text is minimal and generic. Any team can make the collective decision to update the text. Access to modify the text may be limited based on group/project permission level, if you do not have access to the General settings section, please reach out to @mktg-ops via

slack.

Please note this is not an issue but there is no dynamic functionality. The default issue text applies to all issues opened within that project and the text should be broad enough to encompass a roles within that team.

1. Navigate to project to be updated

1. Left side menu, hover over the wheel widget (last icon) -> Select General

1. Scroll down & select Expand next to Default Issue Template

1. In the text box you can add any markdown formatting & modify the text. The text that has been added included several lines above it, so it may appear to be a blank box. Scroll down &/or expand that text box to see complete text.

Please do not delete the labels section.

Label section can be updated to include more labels &/or switch the Department label

Important to leave the mktg-status::plan label in that section

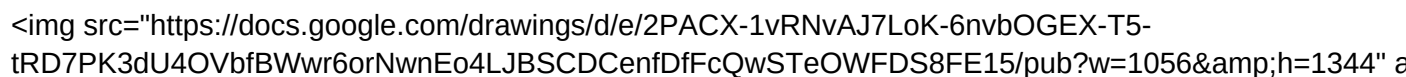
1. Once edits have been made, click Save changes. The changes be applied immediately to any new issue opened.

Does not affect already opened issues.

If you have any issues &/or questions, please reach out to the MktgOps team (@mktg-ops) via slack.

How it all fits together

Figuring out how where and how to create a board, epic, label can be confusing. The following diagram is a very high level example of how it all fits together. If there are questions please ask in the mktgops slack channel (must be GitLab team member for active link).

The diagram is a high-level example of how it all fits together. It is a complex flowchart or organizational chart that details the process of campaign tracking, from initial planning and budgeting through to reporting and analysis. It likely shows the integration of various systems like Salesforce, Coupa, and Navan, as well as the roles of different teams like Marketing and Finance.

How Marketing Tracks Campaign Expenses

Please Note: We are transitioning from the use of Campaign Tags to Allocadia IDs for campaign expense tracking purposes. As a result, we are still detailing out the process below by referencing both Allocadia IDs and Campaign Tags at this time, but eventually we'll be deprecating the use of Campaign Tags.

Marketing Managers track costs associated with campaigns - such as events, content, webcasts, etc. Allocadia IDs/Campaign Tags can be applied to Navan reports, Coupa PO's, corporate credit card charges, and vendor bills processed by Accounts Payable. Campaign expenses that are incurred by independent contractors should be clearly noted with the appropriate ID/tag and included in their invoices to the company. We then use these accumulated costs for budget to actual analysis as well as to update the Salesforce campaigns with actual costs.

Allocadia IDs

Allocadia Handbook Page

Marketing tracks campaign costs utilizing Allocadia line items. Once you have created your line item in Allocadia, follow these instructions.

Campaign Tags

Note: As we move from campaign tags to Allocadia IDs for tracking campaign costs, the below section will eventually be deprecated.

GitLab makes use of campaign tags throughout our systems in order to better track associated costs. For consistency, we use the naming convention of ISODateCampaignShortName. More details on the ISO Date:

- > ISO 8601 provides a standard cross-national approach that says:
 - >
 - >
 - > A general-to-specific approach, forming a date that is easier to process - thus, the year first, followed by month, then day
 - > Numbers less than 10 preceded by a leading zero
 - > Years expressed as "0" prior to year 1 and as "-1" for the year prior to year 0 (and so forth)
 - > Thus, March 30, 1998 would be: 19980330.

Once you have created your Campaign Tag, follow these instructions.

How to Create and Manage Allocadia IDs/Campaign Tags

1. Marketing Managers and Field Marketing Coordinators request the creation of an Allocadia ID or Campaign Tag in this tracker. They will add all requested details outlined in the tracker.

The GL accounting team will create the IDs/tags at the end of each day.

The ID/tag is created in NetSuite and syncs with Navan and Coupa.

1. The Allocadia ID/Campaign Tag must be noted in the Coupa requisition and in the main tactic issue (for Field Marketing, this information lives under the Event Details section in the main issue). Additional details on the Allocadia > Coupa integration can be found [here](#).

1. Information on utilizing Allocadia IDs for SFDC campaign creation can be found [here](#).

For the MCM team, additional details can be found in the campaign epic.

Postponement of Tactics

If your event or tactic gets postponed to a new date, you only need to request an update to the Allocadia ID/Campaign Tag date in this tracker if the date pushes more than six months from the original tactic date. If postponement date is within six months of the original date, no requested adjustment is required to the Allocadia ID/Campaign Tag.

Travel Costs

Travel expenses (food, hotel stays, airline tickets, etc.) must also be tracked utilizing Allocadia IDs/Campaign Tags. You will include the Allocadia ID/Campaign Tag in the classification field in Navan when you are completing your expense report. The instructions for how to request the Allocadia ID/Camp